

AtlasIT.Pro Site QA Review

Overview

AtlasIT.pro is a web-based compliance and access-management platform. After authentication, users land in a dark-themed dashboard that offers navigation to Directory, Compliance (controls, evidence, policies, insights, packs, analytics), Access Reviews, Access Requests, Incidents, Non-Human Identity (NHI) governance, JML (joiners/movers/leavers) changelog, and Automation (workflows, rules, runs, connected apps). The interface relies heavily on dynamic tables and graphs, with primary navigation located in a persistent left sidebar.

User Experience (UX) & Interface Quality

Visual Design & Dark Mode

- **Dark-theme readability** – The entire console is rendered in dark colors with muted purples and blues. The contrast between text and background is borderline in several places; for example, the grey secondary text on dark purple cards in the dashboard and compliance pages is difficult to read, especially at small sizes. The WCAG 2.2 Success Criterion 1.4.3 requires a contrast ratio of at least **4.5:1** for normal-sized text and **3:1** for large text ¹. Several UI elements (labels, secondary navigation tabs, disabled buttons) appear to fall below these ratios. Poor contrast makes the interface inaccessible to users with reduced vision and may cause eye strain.

Recommendation: Use an online contrast checker to validate all color pairings and adjust colors to meet or exceed WCAG AA guidelines. Offer an optional light-mode toggle for environments where dark mode is uncomfortable. Nielsen Norman Group notes that although dark mode is popular, it is not essential; users still maintain similar behaviours without it and designs must be tested carefully to avoid typical dark-mode issues ².

- **Typography and spacing** – Font sizes vary widely; for example, the evidence table uses small text while section headings are large. At smaller sizes, condensed fonts combined with low contrast reduce legibility. Generous line spacing and consistent fonts would improve readability. Use responsive typographic scales that adapt to screen sizes.
- **Iconography and color cues** – Icons are minimal, leaving navigation dependent on text labels. For example, the “New Campaign” and “New Incident” buttons in Access Reviews/Incidents pages use only text. Introducing clear icons beside actions can improve discoverability. Error messages should use high-contrast colors and distinct icons; NN/g recommends using bold, high-contrast text and redundant indicators rather than relying solely on color ³.

Navigation & Information Architecture

- **Left-sidebar hierarchy** – The main navigation is grouped into *Access Management*, *Compliance*, *Automation*, *Apps*, and *System*. While the grouping is logical, icons or collapsible headings could aid

recognition. Some menu items appear only on scroll (e.g., `Workflows`, `Connected Apps`, `Platform Status`), so users may not realize additional pages exist. Consider adding an indicator (e.g., "+13" more items) or collapsing sections with expand/collapse arrows.

- **Dashboard orientation** – After login the user lands on a dashboard of blank placeholders without instructions. First-time users may be confused by empty states. Provide an onboarding checklist or tooltips to highlight where to begin (e.g., "Connect your IdP in Directory" or "Install a compliance pack"). Use empty-state illustrations and concise explanations to guide users.
- **Consistency between pages** – Some pages (e.g., Policies) display red error banners without context ("Failed to load policies (429)"). Other pages display informative empty states ("No access review campaigns yet"). Align the style of all empty/error states and provide clear actions to resolve them. NN/g emphasises that error messages should be plainspoken, describe the problem clearly, avoid jargon, and be placed near the source of the problem ³ ⁴.

Content Quality & Messaging

- **Error handling** – The Policies section returned an HTTP 429 error with a raw code displayed to the user. Exposing internal error codes (e.g., 429) confuses non-technical users. According to error-message guidelines, messages must be human-readable and avoid technical jargon ⁴.
Recommendation: Intercept 4xx/5xx errors server-side and display user-friendly messages such as "We're experiencing high load; please try again later" alongside a retry button. Offer a "Report this issue" link or automatically retry after a short interval. Additionally, implement proper rate limiting or caching to reduce 429 responses.
- **Grammar & clarity** – Several headings or button labels are ambiguous. For instance, "Evidence" under Compliance shows a list of tasks but lacks context for new users ("Evidence is automatically collected from connected sources"). Use consistent capitalization and microcopy; ensure buttons follow a verb-noun pattern (e.g., "Add User" rather than "New"), and avoid abbreviations (e.g., "NHI" should be defined as "Non-Human Identities" in the navigation bar for clarity).
- **Onboarding & help** – There is no visible help or documentation link within the console. Including a help center link or contextual "?" icons can reduce friction. Provide inline explanations when tasks require prerequisites (e.g., instruct users to connect identity providers before using Directory). For advanced features like automation rules, embed tooltips or "Learn more" links to documentation.

Functional Review

Directory

- **User and group management** – The Directory page lists Users, Groups, Mappings and Non-Human identities. Empty-state messages ("No users found") are shown, but there are no hints about why this might occur or how to add users. Adding a call-to-action (e.g., "Connect your identity provider to import users" or "Add user manually") would improve discoverability. Provide a search bar and filters when lists grow.

Compliance

- **Controls & Evidence** – The Controls tab provides a table with status badges, coverage percentage and risk categories. The evidence tab lists hundreds of evidence items with statuses. The table uses column widths that require horizontal scrolling; this is manageable on desktop but may break on smaller screens. Consider enabling column resizing, providing a summary view, or offering quick filters to narrow items.
- **Policies** – Loading failures should be gracefully handled, as noted above. Additionally, a library of example policies with descriptions would help new users create or import compliance policies.
- **Insights & Analytics** – The Compliance Insights and Analytics pages display charts showing coverage and gaps. They look polished but lack interactive legends or tooltips explaining metrics. Adding hover tooltips and exporting options (CSV/PNG) would enhance value. Provide context explaining how metrics are calculated (e.g., “Coverage = number of controls passed / total controls”).
- **Packs** – The Packs page lists compliance packs (e.g., GDPR, HIPAA) with **Install** buttons. There is no preview or summary describing each pack’s scope. Provide brief descriptions, estimated control counts, and prerequisites. Consider grouping packs by category (privacy, security, industry) and allowing search.

Access Reviews & Requests

- **Access Reviews** – The page indicates no campaigns exist. Provide guidance such as “Start a new review to ensure users have appropriate access rights” and explain the benefits of periodic access reviews. Allow templates for common review types (e.g., quarterly user recertification).
- **Access Requests** – The form to create an access request is visible but lacks validation feedback. Implement inline validation and explain required fields. Include guidance on how approvals are routed. Provide a history tab showing requests by status (pending, approved, denied).

Incidents & NHI Governance

- **Incidents** – The incidents page invites users to create a new incident. Provide sample categories and severity levels. Offer integration with ticketing systems (e.g., Jira, ServiceNow) and display incident metrics on the dashboard.
- **Non-Human Identities (NHI)** – The NHI page explains that credentials can be discovered through connected adapters. Provide a clearer explanation of what NHIs represent and why they matter. Offer a link to documentation about NHI governance.

JML Changelog

- **Joiners/Movers/Leavers** – The JML changelog lists events with timestamps. Consider adding filters (e.g., time range, event type) and search. Provide a visual timeline of JML events to help administrators quickly identify unusual patterns.

Automation

- **Workflows** – The Workflows page displays run results and statistics but offers little guidance on creating new workflows. Provide a “Create new workflow” wizard with templates for common tasks (e.g., onboarding). Offer visual diagrams of workflow sequences.
- **Rules** – Rules pages allow conditional auto-provisioning. Provide example rules and validations. The table is complex; allow grouping and search. Ensure that rule conditions and actions are clearly labelled to avoid misconfigurations.
- **Runs** – The Runs tab shows logs of workflow executions. Add filters, search, and the ability to export logs. Provide context (e.g., which workflow triggered the run) and highlight failed runs with recommended remediation steps.

Apps and System

- **Connected Apps** – Add an overview explaining how to connect external applications and what data will be imported. Provide icons for popular connectors (e.g., Okta, Google Workspace) to improve recognition. Ensure connectors have status badges and error handling.
- **Marketplace** – If offering additional apps or services, ensure clear categorization and consistent card design. Provide ratings and reviews or at least documentation links.
- **Discovery** – Clarify what discovery entails (e.g., scanning for unregistered applications) and how it benefits compliance.
- **Platform Status** – Provide a status page indicating uptime, planned maintenance, and historical incidents. Offer subscription to status notifications.
- **Settings** – Ensure settings are categorized logically (e.g., Account settings, Organization, Security). Include tooltips and default values. Provide audit logs of changes for compliance.

Accessibility Considerations

- **Color contrast** – As noted earlier, ensure all text and interactive elements meet the minimum contrast ratios of **4.5:1** (normal text) or **3:1** (large text) ¹. Evaluate interactive states (hover, focus, disabled) and provide focus outlines for keyboard navigation.
- **Keyboard navigation** – Some interactive elements (tabs, table rows) may not be easily reachable via keyboard alone. Conduct testing to ensure all elements are reachable in a logical tab order and have visible focus indicators.
- **ARIA labels and alt text** – Chart components and icons should include appropriate ARIA labels so screen readers convey their purpose. Provide alt text for logos and decorative images.

- **Responsive design** – The console appears designed for desktop. Test on tablets and smaller screens to ensure tables break into card layouts or enable horizontal scrolling. Provide a responsive menu that collapses elegantly.

Security & Privacy Observations

- The platform deals with sensitive identity and access data. Ensure that all pages enforce HTTPS and implement secure headers (HSTS, CSP). Mask sensitive information (e.g., user emails) until necessary to reveal. Provide a visible privacy notice explaining what data is collected and how it is processed.
- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) appears absent from the login flow we observed. Encourage organizations to enforce MFA for administrative users. Provide SSO integration with enterprise identity providers.

Performance & Reliability

- **Rate limiting / caching** – The 429 error indicates that API calls may be rate limited. Optimize API usage on the client side by implementing caching and batching of requests. Provide back-off strategies to automatically retry after headers' `Retry-After` durations. Inform users when background evaluations (e.g., evidence collection) are in progress to reduce repeated actions.
- **Loading states** – Several pages show spinners or blank placeholders while loading data. Provide skeleton loaders or progress indicators with estimated completion times. For long-running tasks (e.g., compliance scans), consider asynchronous notifications rather than blocking UI.

Overall Recommendations

1. **Improve color contrast and provide a light-mode option.** Adjust foreground/background combinations to meet WCAG 4.5:1 contrast requirements ¹. Offer a light-mode toggle to accommodate varied user preferences ².
2. **Enhance error handling and messaging.** Replace raw error codes with human-readable explanations and actionable next steps. Follow NN/g guidelines by placing error messages near the problematic element, using high-contrast visuals, and avoiding jargon ³ ⁴.
3. **Provide onboarding and contextual help.** Use empty-state illustrations with concise instructions, tooltips, and links to documentation. Offer an onboarding checklist guiding users to connect identity providers, install compliance packs, and configure workflows.
4. **Refine navigation and discoverability.** Add icons or collapsible sections in the sidebar to improve scanning. Indicate additional hidden menu items. Provide search across the platform and quick filters in tables.
5. **Standardize typography and microcopy.** Use consistent font sizes and spacing. Write button labels and headings in clear, action-oriented language. Define abbreviations on first use.

6. **Build responsive and accessible components.** Ensure that tables, charts, and forms adapt to smaller screens, are keyboard navigable, and include descriptive ARIA labels. Provide focus outlines and skip navigation options.

7. **Add context to metrics and analytics.** Display tooltips or footnotes explaining how coverage or risk scores are computed. Offer export options for reports and evidence.

8. **Integrate security best practices.** Provide MFA and SSO options, enforce HTTPS, and show a clear privacy notice. Ensure that sensitive data is masked by default and that audit trails are available.

By addressing these issues and implementing the recommendations above, AtlasIT can significantly improve the usability, accessibility, and reliability of its compliance and access-management platform.

1 Understanding Success Criterion 1.4.3: Contrast (Minimum) | WAI | W3C

<https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/contrast-minimum.html>

2 Dark Mode: How Users Think About It and Issues to Avoid - NN/G

<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/dark-mode-users-issues/>

3 4 Error-Message Guidelines - NN/G

<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/error-message-guidelines/>